# King Kitekere

## Performed by Abdallah “Feza” Kaluandila

Translated and edited by P.S.

Abdallah Feza's Kitekere is a richly detailed tableau of the royal court of one of the most famous kings of Hayaland. Within its frame appear courtly activities, roles, institutions, ideologies and, of course, language arts. At the center is Kitekere himself, a famous nineteenth-century King of Kyamtwara Kingdom, drawn not so much naturalistically, perhaps, as according to general perceptions about the Haya kingship and about the particular significance of his reign. His reign is significant because King Kitekere was not born to a ruling family. His father, Rushuma, was a regent who, at the behest of the dying King Kalemera IV, protected the latter's young son and designated heir, Kajurunga, until he was old enough to rule. In an attempt to attain the kingship, Kajurunga's half-brother, Kinyonyi, killed Rushuma. Kitekere avenged his father's death by driving Kinyonyi into exile. Kitekere established Kajurunga as the titular ruler and ritual king and himself as the head of state, thus creating the Bankango clan's dynasty in Kyamtwara. Kaitaba (the ballad about him is also found in this collection), was Kitekere's son, and enjoyed the same kind of relationship with Kajurunga's son, Kimiro - called Bwogi (IV) in King Kaitaba. (History from Fredrick J. Kaijage. 1971. "Kyamutwara," Journal of World History 13(3):542-574) The personal power of Kitekere - the man who established his own dynasty - is often referred to in the ballad. To be sure, all protagonist kings are portrayed as powerful; kings were the embodiments of the state, the legitimate controllers of the institutions that could organize and direct the greatest numbers of people - the judiciary, the army, the educational system, and to some extent the religion. But Kitekere's portrait seems especially embellished with the trappings of power, in his appearance, his gestures, his words, and in the ways others refer to him. All the more astounding, therefore, that Kitekere, in the key episode in the ballad, does not answer the verbal abuse he suffers from the impassioned speech of a lowly cowherd. The rhetorical form of this abuse, moreover, clearly echoes that of the scolding given a young wife near the beginning of the ballad. The king holds his tongue, as the young wife did. This almost unimaginable forbearance on the part of the volcanic monarch is a sign of great virtue, of strong allegiance to an important ethical value of Kitekere's royal state. Abdallah "Feza" Kaluandila performed the ballad at the house of his friend Kagombola, a mufumu, or healer of spiritually caused diseases, on June 19, 1980. It was an act of great artistic concentration, as the performance context was very informal, to say the least.

PLOT OUTLINE

**Lines 1-8:**
The ballad begins with epithets of praise for King Kitekere.

**Lines 9-21:**
During the night, a spirit medium is roused unwillingly from a sleep by his youngest wife.

NOTES

1-3 The bard praises King Kitekele as a bull who defends the herd fro other bulls and represents it with an identity proclaimed far and wide. "Appear" is is the greeting given to a king to recognize his presence; he becomes visible socially, as the sun does radiantly, passing from behind a cloud.

4 Scourge, or switch, akati, literally a small wooden stick, which can be used to discipline a child. This image of praise is elaborated on line 46.

6-7 A leopard causes howls of pain among hunting dogs tethered outside, which it attacks at night. The audacious and unpredictable leopard also attacks humans. Kahigi I was the last, strong, Hinda monarch that ruled before Kitekele seized control of the throne. The two kings were also related by marriage, as Kahigi's wife Matiti was a member of the Bankango clan, as was Kitekele.

9 A dream also bears important information at the opening of *Kachwenyanja* . The first scene of Kaitaba, the epic about Kitekele's son, portrays the

*Appear to us, Protector-Bull.*
*Appear to us, Protector-Bull.*
*White one, Proclaims-the-herd-from-afar,*
*Little scourge of fearful rulers,*
*You are a child of Igalami and Bashaija,*
*Of the Raiser-of-Howls in early morning,*
*Climber-of-men Giant leopard of Kahigi,*
*My lord, Protector-Bull,*

When I lay down to sleep I dreamed,
Awake I started with a big head roaring.
"My lord may this big head burst!
This head be bound with stones!
This head be bound with kaihyula herb!"

In our house I'd recently been married.
Inside I have a new bride.

king's troubled, sleepless night, as does another classic epic ballad, Muhata. Night and dreams frame the ensuing action within the dimensions of an unseen world, with which some actors resonate.

13-14 Tying stones on one's head or applying kaiyula herb are said to be treatments for headache.

Habuka Muhimbile-ngundu.
Habuka Muhimbile-ngundu.
*Kitale lulanga mahyo,*
*Akati k' engoma ilikwekonya,*
*Niwe lwa Igalami na Bashaija,*
*Lwa Mboigozi omutulankya,*
*Luhalatana empisi mpango eya Kahigi,*
*Waitu, Muhimbile-ngundu,*

Kananyama nalota,
Kusisimuka kitwe yampinda.
"Waitu, kitwe nekatike!
Kitwe nekashengw' amabale!
"Kitwe nekashengw' enyihyula!

Omwaitu nkaba nshweile juba.
Nyinamu omugole.

POETIC STANZAS

1-8: passage of linegroups (1-2, 3-4, 5-7, 8) that cohere by parallel syntax (3-4: noun initial (cf 43-44); 5-6: possessive particle initial (cf 503-504)), by common semantic features (6-7: wild animal (cf 504-505)), and by repetition (1-2, 8) that creates a pattern in **aba** .

9-13: stanza in **aabb** b formed by contrast between lines that contain an initial subordinate verb and a main indicative verb ( **a** 's: 9, 10) and lines that begin with "head" and contain a main subjunctive verb.

PLOT OUTLINE

**Lines 22-37:**
They argue.

NOTES

16-19 These lines were not sung during the performance recorded. I inserted them at the request of the singer.

16-17 These fish are symbols of feminine virtues. The one named *bifu* (by appearance a kind of catfish) and the one alluded to as *Ebitabologa* (literally, those-which-do-not-bellow - *emamba* , the lungfish) symbolize smoothness of skin and bravery under duress, respectively. The meaning of the latter trope is explored in the note to *The Place You Come From* : 20.

18-19 These lines of praise seem to have a parallel rhetorical structure: among seats, the bride deserves the throne; among roads that help construct identity (cf., *The Place You Come From* : 16-18), hers is the major thoroughfare to the kingdom of Bugabo.

20 *Bunyana* , literally, Place-of-calfs, accords the bride high prestige. Like the king-bull tropes, it articulates a poetics of cattle which will be very productive in the epic.

24 *Enkuku* are the hand's middle knuckles one uses to knock on a door, not the upper ones you might apply to an adversary's jaw.

33-37 This passage of verbal abuse is structured as a conditional relationship between clauses that are contrary-to-fact and hyperbolic, respectively. This is an instance of the rhetorical figure known as adynaton. The bard uses the same rhetorical structure later at a climactic moment, 250-254

[ *Appear! Child of Bifu fish of Kitahya.*
*Bellowers-that-keep-silent lake Ikimba is your home.*
*Child of the Bugabo road.*
*I place before you a throne to sit.* ]
*Her name is Beloved-one of Bunyana.*
*She-makes-a-man-feel-shame is certain that she's loved.*

In just the way those women interrupt -
The little woman broke my dream.
What knuckles I tapped her head with!
I hear the little woman soothe me,

"Why chastise me love?
Never have I said an angry word to you.
Nor since the dawn last lightened have we fought."
I say, "I'm hitting you and justly so
Because you broke my dream."
She said, "I was not thinking it a dream."
I was driving off the things that made you moan."

I said, "If you were Nkwanzi Lutane
Or (my other wife) Mabuye of Ntale,
I'd use the edge of a hafted-knife,
And come next day, wife,
Your father and your mother would arbitrate the pieces."

*Habuka Ow' ebifu bya Kitahya.*
*Ebitabologa noluga Ikimba.*
*Oli w' omuhanda gwa Bugabo.*
*Nakutah' ekitebe oli w' enketo.*
*Eibala kalikwenda lwa Bunyana.*
*Kisa-nshoni nayesig' eiganzi.*

Okw' obukazi bubambala -
Akakazi kangutuz' omuloto gwange.
Enkuku 'yonakateka omu mutwe!
Mpulila akakazi kantagiliza.

Kati, "Baba wantulaki?
Nka naba ntakujumile.
Mbali obwile bwakela tutakalwaine."
Nti, "Ninkutela ninkusinga
Kuba wangutuz' omuloto gwange."
Ati, "Omuloto naba ntamanyile."
Naba ninkutais' ebyo kuhunilila."

Nti, "Kuba waba oli Nkwanzi Lutane
Bwangili oli Mabuye lwa Ntale,
Nakukuteile engango y' omuholo.
Kabwakukeile nyenkya omukazi,
Isho na nyoko batulamul' ebibale."

POETIC STANZAS

16-21: passage of three couplets; the first (16-17) and the last (20-21) cohere by semantics: respectively, of fish and of praisenames; the second (18-19) coheres by parallelism; the addition of these lines was requested by the singer after his performance.

22-25: stanza in **abab** formed by contrast between lines that represent a 1st person's thoughts and acts ( **a** 's: 22, 24) and lines that represent those of a "little woman" ( **b** 's: 23, 25).

26-32: compound stanza in **aba** formed by linegroups (each beginning with a locutive) that contrast by conversational turns: the wife's ( **a** 's:26-28, 31-32) and the husband's ( **b** : 29-30).

33-37: stanza in **a** a **bab** formed by semantic contrast between subordinate clauses ( **a** 's: 33-34, 36) and principal clauses ( **b** 's: 35, 37).

PLOT OUTLINE

**Lines 38-49:**
The elder wives ask the medium about the contents of his dream but receive a curt rebuff.

**Lines 50-65:**
The wives help prepare the spirit medium for his journey to the king.

NOTES

41 Muzinza (the more common, Swahili-based spelling) or Muzinja (as it is said in Luhaya) refers to King Kitekele. He is called the Muzinza because his clan, the Bankango of Kyamtwara, asserted its origin in the group of kingdoms to the south of Hayaland known as Buzinja or Zinzaland.

45 45 The symbolic Ant Bear, destroyer of termite mounds, is praise for Kitekele. These mounds are strong images of Hinda rule, doubly meaningful as landmarks of a royally organized insect society and as the form deceased Hinda spirits create when they emerge from the ground.

46 The image in lines 4 and 44 becomes more explicit. The scourge or little stick is domesticated as a little branch ( *akashanju* ), bringing into sharper focus the metaphor of a parent disciplining a child.

47 47 Lyangombe is a ruling spirit from the southern part of Hayaland and beyond. Some place his origin in Congo. He occupies the same exalted position that Wamala does in the Bachwezi pantheon of the north (see Bjerke 1981, 53, for his place among the Bazinza). In a version of the ballad *Mugasha* from southern Hayaland, the fisher-god battles Lyangombe (instead of Wamara) for his daughter's hand in marriage. Kabale is the royal palace in Kyamutwala, the seat of Kitekele's kingship.

48 Kitekele is a seed bull as the founder of the Bankango dynasty. Virility is a principal part of Kitekere's royal symbolism, also seen in the attention paid to his royal mistresses (lines 143-144 and 317-319).

62 Variants of this phrase are used by the singer to punctuate the narrative eight times in *Kitekele* and nine times in *Kaitaba* .

Elder women know.
They arose from sleep prepared.

They said, "What was your dream, spirit-medium?"
I said, "What I dreamed today, tomorrow after dawn, I will prophesy to the Muzinza.
*O Protector-Bull!*
*He is the White-one, Proclaims-the-herd-from-afar,*
*Little scourge of fearful rulers,*
*Appear! Great-tongued one, Breaker-of-termite mounds,*
*Little switch winds lines on kings' behinds.*
*He is Lyangombe of Kabale.*
*Appear! Seed-bull of the Bankango."*
"My lord, what was your dream, spirit medium?"
I said, "What I dreamed today I will prophesy to the Muzinza."

Those women did not delay that day.

Pot they put on the flame.
Pith from a banana plant they used to cleanse me.
Spear they put on sharpening block.
I saw my hafted-knife they polish.

They did not ask another word, the women.

My calabash they cleaned out with stones.
A bit of beer
My lord, they poured enough to sip and think with.
Beer to sip, relax and think with.
With butterfat they rubbed my shins,
A bit, not much, *the Water-of-the-cattle-herdsmen.*

They did not ask another word.

Obukazi obukulu [bumanya].
Bwaimuka bubyekomile.

Buti, "Walotaki mbandwa?"
Nti, "Ebyonalota mbwenu na nyenkya bukeile ndabilangila Omuzinja
*Wa Muhimbile-ngundu!*
*Niwe Kitale Lulanga-mahyo,*
*Akati k' engoma ilikwekonya,*
*Habuka Endimi Lwata-bishwa,*
*Akashanju kakoma abakama aha nyio.*
*Niwe Lyangombe owa Kabale.*
*Habuka embiikile ya Bunkango."*
"Waitu, walotaki embandwa?"
Nti,"Ebyonalota mbwenu ndabigambila Omuzinja."

Obukazi tibwakeleile kilekyo.

Omunaga bwateka aha kyoto.
Akashumu omu ngemu bwandagaza.
Eichumu bwateka aha kilindi.
Nkabon' omuholo gwange bwanyumula.

Tibwabaliz' ekindi obukazi.

Ekilele bwatamu amabale.
Otwalwa tuke tuke
Waitu, bwatamu otwo kulangaiza
Otwalw' otwo kulangaiza.
Amajuta bwanteka aha mulundi,
Gake ti gangi *Kiizi kya bashumba.*

Tibabaliz' ekindi.

POETIC STANZAS

38-61: verse passage in **abab** ab formed by short, generalized narrative descriptions of the "little women" ( **a** 's: 38-39, 50, 55) alternating with linegroups that form stanzaic patterns ( **b** 's: 40-49.1, 51-54, 56-61); the first such linegroup is itself a verse passage formed in **aba** by contrast between a repeated exchange ( **a** 's: 40-41, 49-49.1) and lines of praise ( **b** 's: 42-48); the second such linegroup, completely composed of lines in which the direct object precedes the verb, is a stanza formed in **abab** by contrast between lines in which a prepositional phrase is final ( **a** 's: 51, 53) and lines in which the verb is final ( **b** 's: 52, 54); the third such linegroup is a compound stanza formed in **abb** by contrast between a single line composed like those immediately preceding, direct object + verb phrase ( **a** : 56) and linegroups that elaborate this composition by enjambment combined with repetition or apposition ( **b** 's: 57-59 and 60-61, respectively).

PLOT OUTLINE

**Lines 66-82:**
The spirit medium travels, eventually meeting a ferryman to whom he indicates his mission and provides payment.

**Lines 83-98:**
The spirit medium travels on through several landmarks.

NOTES

65 Point-down is the position of a spear held in readiness while travelling in a dangerous place.

72 The ferryman Bijuli is evidently well known personage, for he also marks a journey through Ntoija and Bukongo in the epic ballad of King Kahigi sung by Muzee.

79 These sighs are voiced. They are named by the same verb ( *oku-sinda* ) that describes the roar of a lion or a bull. The meaningful connection between such deep-voiced sighing and material needs is also evoked in *Kajango* : 5. As a whole, the line means 'pay me.'

POETIC STANZAS

63-65: stanza in **aab** formed by contrast between lines composed as verb + [hide] of + animal ( **a** 's: 63, 64 - word order reversed between them) and a single line that begins with a direct object.

66-72: compound stanza in **a** x **ab** , 2 + 2 + 2, formed by contrast between couplets that cohere by parallelism ( **a** 's:66-67, [68 is interpolated], 69-70) and a single couplet that coheres by enjambment ( **b** : 71-72).

73-80: compound stanza in **aa** a **b** , 2 + 2 + 2 + 2, formed by couplets ( **a** 's: 73-74, 75-76, 77-78) comprised of the quoted speech of a single speaker - which also cohere by enjambment (73-74, 75-76) or repetition (77-78) - contrasted with a single couplet ( **b** : 79-80) comprised of the quoted speech of two speakers - which also coheres by repetition.

88-91: stanza in **abab** formed by contrast between lines that begin with *ninye* + prepositional phrase ( **a** 's: 88, 90) and lines that are not so composed ( **b** 's: 89, 91.

92-97: compound stanza, 2 + 2 + 2, of couplets composed as Ø verb + placename/ verb phrase + placename, formed by contrast between couplets whose second line has an initial verb ( **a** 's: 92-93, 96-97) and a single couplet whose second line begins with a direct object ( **b** : 94-95).

I put on a spotted otter fur,
A black otter sweeps the air.
I held my spear point-down in readiness.

Then I descended into the wilderness of lions.
I climbed the mountain of hyenas.
*My lord*, *Provider*
It was I in Ntoija.
I descended into Bukongo.
At Kyenyabasa's river shore
I cast my eyes on Bujuli the ferryman.

"What is it, spirit medium?
I see you wipe off sweat."
He said, "What I dreamed today, tomorrow
After dawn, I will prophesy to the Muzinza."
Bijuli Bijuli,
Bujuli of Kwenyunga,
"The-cause-of-envious-growls be healed!"
He answered, "Hurry, heal me and we'll see."

He put me in the canoe. The other shore!
I crossed to the mountain of leopards.

My lord, I did not ask another word.

It is I in Kanyina,
In Kanyinayo.
That day I climbed a mountain,

*My lord*, *Provider*

It is I, my lord, at Matembe,
Kihilila and Kyebyazi.
It is I in Kishenye of the munazi trees.
At Hoe-swallower field.

In Kigoye up above
I descended to the fence at Lwiza's in Bwala.
In Kangabushalo at Lwogo's
I crossed the water at Busano.
In Lwamulumba in the middle
I pushed on to the two trees at Kalabagaine.

Nayambala olw' enzo,
Olw' engonge lwakweya.
Eichumu nalikwata ekifute.

Nilwo nasokile omu ly' entale.
Nkabanduka omu ibanga ly' empumi.
*Waitu*, *Lugaba*.
Ninye omuli Ntoija.
Nasok' omuli Bukongo.
Aha lusinde lwa Kyenyabasa
Nagabandana na Bijuli mulimba.

"Wabaki embandwa?
Nka nimbona nolagaza empiita."
Ati,"Ebyonalota mbwenu na nyenkya 'nye
Bukeile ndabilangila Omuzinja.
Bijuli Bijuli,
Bijuli bya Kwenyunga,
Kisindize bakize!"
Ahi,"Yanguha okize tulole."

Yanteka omu kato. Nseli!
Nayambuka akabanga ly'engo.

Waitu, tinabaliz' ekindi.

Ninye omuli Kanyina,
Omuli Kanyinayo.
Kilekyo natemba omu ibanga,

*Waitu*, *Lugaba*.

Ninye waitu, omuli Matembe,
Kihilila na Kyebyazi.
Ninyeomu Kishenye ekya minazi.
Omu Kamezile-nfuka.

Kigoye eigulu
Nasoka omu lugo omwa Lwiza Bwala.
Kangabushalo omwa Lwogo
Amaizi nagambuka omuli Busano.
Lwamulumba omugati
Nashubiz' emiti ebili Kalabagaine.

PLOT OUTLINE

**Lines 99-140:**
At the outskirts of the palace compound, the guards he meets question the feasibility of his mission, and he answers them, demonstrating his knowledge of court life.

NOTES

107 This line was not sung but inserted by me at the singer's request.

114 This court officer controlled access to the king's court. His name, Gahulwa, derives from *okw-ahula* , "to pick over and select," as one removes small stones in preparing rice or separates truth from falsehood in listening to the news. Gahulwa chose who and what would be passed to the king.

128 A king was called the Straightener: he restored equilibrium through just judicial decisions; he dispensed rewards for service to the state; he punished wrongdoing; and through ritual and other means he maintained relationships with unseen spiritual forces.

POETIC STANZAS

99-101: stanza in **aab** formed by contrast between lines comprised of prepositional phrases ( **a** 's: 99, 100) and a single line comprised of a main clause ( **b** : 101).

102-113: verse of two compound stanzas, 2 + 1 + 2 and 2 + 3 + 2, which have essentially the same final couplets; they are both comprised of quoted speech and formed in **aba** by contrast in speakers: the Abayondo guards ( **a** 's: 102-103, 105-106 and 107-108, 112-113) and the spirit medium ( **b** 's: 104 and 109-111).

114-119: compound stanza in **aab** , 2 + 2 + 2, formed by contrast in speakers: the Abayondo guards ( **a** 's: 114-115, 116-117) and the spirit medium ( **b** : 118-119).

120-123: stanza in **aa** a **b** formed by contrast between lines that name gifts ( **a** 's: 120, 121, 122) and a single line composed only of verbs ( **b** : 123).

129-133: stanza in **ab** b **ab** formed by lines that contain *golola* "sets (things) straight" in a query or an assertion of the guards' ignorance ( **a** 's: 129, 132) contrasted with solutions to the puzzle, first ironic, then direct ( **b** 's:130, 131, 133).

*O Protector-Bull!*

In Nyanga-ya-Iyele.
In Byonyu-bishaija field.
Lo my eye is met by Abayondo clansmen.

"What is it spirit medium what is it?
We see you wipe off sweat."
He said, "In the king's presence I beg leave to offer a salutation."
They said, "The man's drunk beer in the light of dawn.
You seem intoxicated.

[Fellow, we pity you].
How will you reach him to salute?"
He said, "In the royal court, is there an illness?
Or is there an order that it be cleared?
Or is there a great misfortune?"
"The man's drunk beer in the light of dawn.
To me he seems intoxicated.

There is Gahulwa, Gahulwa,
*The Binding-rope, Blind in one eye.*
With his quarter-staff, *Wraps-it-up-easily*,
He cracks Bahyoza's backs.
He said, "He's beating them and justly so.
They bring his beating on themselves.

When I set down a calabash of beer,
Then add a roll of tobacco,
A festive packet, look, of coffee berries,
He'll free me to go and salute."

He did not ask another word.

He said, "Himself, in which house is he now?
Which house?"
They said, "That man! Look here,
There is the *Straightener-who-never-fails* ."

"How does he straighten, the king?
Does he chop folk with hafted-knives
Or does he ply them with medicines?
Or does he, perhaps, massage the body?
If you don't know the way he straightens -
*The Owner-of-bulls* straightens with property.

*Ah Muhimbile-ngundu!*

Omuli Nyanga-ya-Iyele.
Omu Byonyu-bishaija.
Leba kaisho ntanganwa Abayondo.

"Wabaki embandwa wabaki?
Nka nitubona nolagaza empiita."
Ati, "Obuso inye nintongana ekilamyo."

Bati, "Omushaija anyoile amalwa obukyakya.
Nkanoshana nka atamile.

[Omushaija ntukuganyila.]
Olalaba nkaha kulamya?"
Ati, "Obuso aliyo obushasi?
Bwangili aliyo omwihyo?
Bwangili aliyo ekiyengo?"
"Omushaija anyoile amalwa olukyakya.
Nka nimbona nka nashana nka atamile.

Alio Gahulwa, Gahulwa,
*Nkome Kaisho kaigaile.*
Aina enkoni *y' Omukoma-mpango* ,
Abahyoza nalichwa omu gongo.
Ahi, "Nabatela nabasinga.
Manti leba nibo balikumweteza."

Kandataho engunda y' amalwa,
Nkataho omutana gw' etaba,
Olushankala leba lw' emwani,
Alantaishula ngende kulamya."

Tiyabaliz' ekindi.

Ati,"Wenene asingile njuki?
Asingile njuki?"
Bati, "Omushaija ogu leba,
Alimu *Omugolozi atosha* ."

"Nagolol' ata omukama?
Abantu natema n' emiholo
Angili nasiga omubazi?
Angili leba nanyuka omubili?
Kolaba otamanya okwo agolola -
*Lwamanumi* nagoloza ebintu.

When he grants you a farm in Katoma,
'The birthplace of a family is land.'
When he grants you cattle and a farm,
They are, my lord, the spoils he took at Kabizimbo."

Oh Provider!

"We hear the Chew-you-up troop is making accusations.
The Mulalamba troop clutch his knees.
When we left, his strategy in mankala was 'stockpile'.
The king was playing 'cattle herd.'

He's leaned against Njwanga,
But his pupils seek Lutwiga.
Ilamulila 'bleeds cattle with a dart.'
When we left Lwela had 'tied the banana bast.'"

He said, " *Conqueror-of-many* and Kemukyalo
Are the ones with whom he plays the mankala.
*My lord*, *Provider*
*My lord*, *Provider*
And Katogoita Kaishamako
*A Shield-breaker* sent by Nkwele."

He did not ask another word.

He descended to Kigenda-kuzimu.
To Byonyu-bishaija he climbed.
Kaitaba and the Stinger troop
He saw him running them in competition.
Byanjweli, *Trammeler-of-spearshafts* ,
Was setting stockade posts.

He did not ask another word.

Olw' alikuha ekibanja Katoma,
'Obuzalilwa eka nibwo butaka.'
Olw' alikuha ente n' ekibanja,
Ebi waitu nibyo yanyagaga Kabizimbo."

Oh Lugaba!

"Twahulila Ekilakulya nikitoija.
Omulalamba nakwata amagulu.
Twasiga nayesha obulaza.
Omukama nayesh' ekikumba.

Ayegekeile Njwanga,
Emboni nazihanga Lutwiga.
Ilamulila 'yamuchw' omutezi.'
Twasiga Lwela 'akomeleile ekyahi.'"

Ahi, " *Nalwiha-bangi* na Kemukyalo
Abo nibo alikwesha nabo olwesho.
*Waitu*, *Lugaba*.
*Waitu*, *Lugaba*.
Katogoita Kaishamako
*Mwenda-ngabo* atumilwemu Nkwele."

Tiyabaliz' ekindi.

Yasoka omu Kigenda-kuzimu.
Omu Byonyu-bishaija yatemba.
Kaitaba n' Ekibuli
Akabona nahakanisa okwilukisa.
Byanjweli, *Ikoma-mango* ,
Ogw' akaba nazitiza mugogo.

Tiyabaliz' ekindi.

PLOT OUTLINE

**Lines 141-160:**
On being asked, the guards tell the spirit medium that the king is in a grove playing the game of mankala. The spirit medium proceeds towards the palace and sees warriors practicing military skills.

NOTES

135 The word translated as "family" is *eka* . More properly a "household," an *eka* may vary in the types of kin included within it.

139-140 These fragmentary glimpses of court life (like those in *Kajango* : 389-389.2) portray the dangers of its powerful hierarchy, here, accusations and submissive pleas for forgiveness made by clutching the king's knees.

142 Mankala in Hayaland is called *olwesho* and is played on a board of four rows of eight cups with 64 pea-size counters. Similar equipment is used in other east African societies - Rwanda, Ganda, Swahili, et al - but is played with different rules. Haya *olwesho* has conventional openings, and contestants choose strategically from among them. There are many such opening arrangements of counters in cups, among them those named in lines 141-142, 'stockpile' and 'cattle herd.' Play progresses as contestants choose among possible moves. Typical strategic sequences in play are figuratively named with verbal phrases like those mentioned in lines 145-146, 'bled cattle with a dart' and 'tied the banana bast.' Strategic play requires mentally keeping track of complexly embedded strings of numbers, a capability not unlike that evident in the more elaborate stanzaic structures of heroic verse.

152 Shield-breaker is the praisename for a resident of Bugabo kingdom, whose first Hinda king, Nkwele, was a contemporary of Kitekele, according to the sources consulted by Cory (1959).

POETIC STANZAS

134-137: stanza in **abab** by contrast between lines composed as "when he gives you" + named asset ( **a** 's: 134, 136) and lines that praise or qualify that act ( **b** 's: 135, 137).

139-152: a compound stanza, 4 + 4 + 6, formed in **aab** by two pairs of couplets ( **a** 's: 139-142, 143-146), each pair composed of one couplet that depicts the king's authority or virility (139-140, 143-144 whose parallel lines are composed respectively as troop name + verb phrase, and verb phrase + woman's name) and one couplet that depicts a mankala game (141-142, 145-146, whose parallel lines are composed respectively as ..."he plays" + strategy name, and man's name + verb phrase) contrasted with a linegroup ( **b** : 147-152) of three couplets that in turn form a figure of **aba** by contrast between two couplets composed as personal names/ appositive + verb phrase ( **a** 's: 147-148, 151-152) and a single couplet that coheres by repetition ( **b** : 149-150).

154-159: compound stanza, 2 + 2 + 2, formed in **abb** by two couplets composed as personal names/ verb phrase comprising distant past + present continuative ( **b** 's: 156-157, 158-159) contrasted with a single couplet ( **a** : 154-155) whose lines cohere by a inversion of syntax and semantics: initial verb (descend) + prepositional phrase/ prepositional phrase + final verb (climb).

PLOT OUTLINE

**Lines 161-183:**
He meets the guardian of the royal court and provides gifts. The spirit medium proceeds to an audience with the king.

**Lines 184-213:**
He greets the king and presents his prophecy that warns about a particular warrior. The king receives the information favorably.

NOTES

163 Guardhouse translates bulwani, literally, "place of the Balwani clan," the clan entrusted with the duty of guarding the palace in the kingdom of Kyamutwala

184-194 With this ornate salutation to the king in his palace at Kabale, the key episode of the heroic ballad begins, its Call to action. This is a very elaborate one. The greeting begins like its cognate in *Kachwenyanja* (lines 69-69.2) but greatly amplifies the theme of power difference between the spirit-medium and the founder of the Bankango dynasty.

POETIC STANZAS

162-165: stanza formed by inversion of composition in succeeding couplets: dependent phrase (prepositional)/ main clause (162-163); main clause/ dependent phrase (praise).

166-171: compound stanza, 2 + 2 + 2, formed in **aab** by contrast in speakers: spirit medium ( **a** 's: 166-167, 168-169) and palace guard ( **b** : 170-171); each couplet coheres internally by parallelism and repetition

172-177: stanza of two triplets, a variant of **aabb** , formed by three parallel lines ( **a** 's: 172-174) contrasted with a triplet ( **b** 's: 175-177) that forms a pattern of **aab** by repetition and contrast.

178-183: two three-line linegroups associated by repetition of the initial word in their final lines, "I saw" (180, 183); lines in the first linegroup (178-180) do not seem to cohere, but those in the second linegroup (181-183) form a stanza in **aab** by contrast between prepositional phrases ( **a** 's: 181, 182) and a principal clause ( **b** : 183).

184-194: compound stanza in **aa** aa **b** , 3 + 2 + 2 + 3 + 1 formed by contrast between linegroups that cohere internally by repetition and/or parallelism ( **a** 's: 184-186, 187-188, 189-190, 191-193) and a single, unique line.

*Oh Protector-Bull!*

By the royal approach-road
My lord, he reached the guardhouse.
He met Gahulwa,
Gahulwa, *The Binding-rope*, *Blind in one eye* .

"Respectful greetings, Gahulwa,
Respectful greetings, *Binding-rope of the Vanguard*
He said, "My lord, I beg leave...
My lord, in the king's presence I beg leave to offer a salutation."
"Easy does it, fellow
Be assured that easy does it."

A calabash of beer,
A roll of tobacco,
A festive packet of coffee berries,
"Go quickly, salute the king, fellow.
Go quickly, salute the king.
I'm coming to the royal court to order it be cleared."

With his special garments on his back
It was he in the royal approach road.
I saw him enter the gate.

At the iron bars that chime a warning,
At the fire of the Brown-flecked Bull,
I saw him strike his leather cloak to sit.

"Live forever,
Live forever, *Father creator*.
Live forever, *Great-one-before-whom-I-am-powerless*.
I salute you with a greeting of fear,
I also place before you one to buy my life.
For the Bankango of Kabale are easily angered
Men are killed for nothing.
You might put out my eyes,
You might put out my eyes,
And also cut my legs -
See! In the royal approach-road, I shoo away the birds from drying crops.

*Lwa Muhimbile-ngundu!*

Nyalulembo mwonene
Waitu, yagoba omuli Bulwani.
Yamushangamu Gahulwa,
*Gahulwa olwa nkome kaisho kaigaile* .

"Shumalamu Gahulwa,
Shumalamu *Nkomeza Kibanda*
Ati, "Waitu, nintongana...
Waitu, obuso nintongana ekilamyo."

"Mushaija mpola make mushaija
Manti leba mpola make."

Engunda y' amalwa,
Omutana gw' etaba,
Olushankala lw' emwani,
"Iloko olamye mushaija.
Iloko olamye.
Obuso ninyija kwitayo omwihyo."

Zalalila aha mabega
Niw' ogwo omuli nyalulembo.
Nkabona yataha ekihigi.

Omu ibobo lwantakya,
Aha komi ya Lugondo,
Nkabona yalutela yalwikalila.

"Kamelele,
Kamelele, *Ishowanga*.
Kamelele, *Ishozalyange*.
Ninkulamya eky' obutini,
Ninshuba ninkutaho eky' obwegula mwoyo.
Kuba Bankango ba Kabale muboya
Lebamwitila busha abantu.
Wakunyihyamu amaisho,
Wakunyihyamu amaisho,
Oshuba ontema n' amagulu -
Nyalulembo leba nshuhya amanyonyi.

PLOT OUTLINE

**Lines 213-243:**
An alarm is heard, and guesses as to its origin in the hunt are offered and dismissed with arguments based on conventions of poetic praise.

NOTES

200 The name Munyaitoju means "resident of Itoju village." According to the historical traditions recorded by Kaijage, Munyaitoju was Kitekele's distant cousin. Munyaitoju's father, Kitekele's father's sister's husband, was the last Hinda king of Kyamutwala, Kalemera II, so, in this version of Kymutwalan history, Munyitoju was a rival for the throne that Kitekele and his father, Rushuma, wrested from Hinda control.

203 Climbs a buffalo's face is a praise that signifies fearlessness.

205 Munyaitoju's burning of a royal drum is a story unknown to me. Burning is an act of war and proper to warrior praise, but the drum could be a kingdom, or a kingship, or just the royal instrument and ensign itself.

209-210.1 Here called simply *enjoka* (snake), an individual's life serpent is said to be the center of personhood, the seat of thinking and desire, as in *Rukiza* 171.2.

214 The cry heard is a ululation, like the keening a woman does when she learns of a death in the family. Or it may be the sound of an alarm raised to announce the advent of another kind unlucky event. Or it may just be the noise of high spirits raised in celebration. This extended puzzle of interpretation, its eventual solution, together with the spirit-medium's report of his dream, forms the richly meaningful episode that generates the ethical Call to action.

POETIC STANZAS

195-199: stanza in **aabb** b formed by contrast between lines composed as dependent verb + main clause ( **a** 's: 195, 196) and lines composed as "my lord" + "head" + verb phrase ( **b** 's: 197, 198, 199).

When I lay down to sleep I dreamed,
Awake I started with a big head roaring.
"My lord may this big head burst!
My lord, this head be bound with stones!
My lord, this head be bound with kaihyula herb!

I dreamed of a man of Itoju, Stern-face,
A man of Itoju, Stern-face,
A man of Itoju, Stern-face,
*Tse-tse fly that climbs a buffalo's face,*
*First fruit of Kalemera,*
*He burned a royal drum while still a youth.*
I dreamed he camped on Cowrie Mountain
And came striding along to Kyabagenzi."

He said, "Easy does it, fellow.
You say what my serpent describes.
If this comes to pass today, tomorrow I
Will give you what your serpent wants.

Go to the Bayondo clansmen, they'll cook you plantains."
Plantains did they go and peel.
When the plantain pot made simmering sounds
We heard a cry from Kalabagaine.

He said, "What cry is this?"
What is this cry, Bayoza?
It is a cry that stops the heart."

200-207: compound stanza, 3 + 3 + 2, formed in **aab** by contrast between three-line linegroups that name the cattle raider ( **a** 's: 200-201, 202-205 - repeated proper name and serial praisenames, respectively) and a couplet that describes his actions ( **b** : 206-207) and coheres by parallel use of final prepositional phrases.

208-210.1: stanza in **abcb** formed by contrast between lines that cohere by parallel use of a relative clause ( **b** 's: 209, 210.1) and those that do not ( **a** and **c** : 208, 210, respectively).

Kananyama nalota,
Kusisimuka kitwe yampinda.
"Waitu, kitwe nekatike!
Waitu, kitwe nekashengw' amabale!
Waitu, kitwe nekashengw' enyihyula!

Nalota Munyaitoju Lukamba,
Munyaitoju Lukamba,
Munyaitoju Lukamba,
*Kijuju mpamb' embogo omubuso,*
*Ekyalabile mbele ekya Kalemela,*
*Ayayoky' engoma y' omukama ali mulenzi.*
Nalota atekeile omu Gwensimbi
Nagalaijuka kwija omu Kyabagenzi."

Ahi, "Mpola make mushaija
Wagamba eky' enjoka elikutala.
Kakyakuba mbwenu na nenkya nanye
Nakuha eky' enjoka elikugonza.

Iloko Buyondo, bakuchumbile ebitoke."
Ebitoke bagya babihata.
Kabyabaile byatagata ekibunu
Tuhulil' endulu Kalabagaine.

Ati,"Kiki endulu egyo?"
Endulu kiki Muyoza?
Nka endulu yamala omwoyo."

211-214: stanza in **aab** formed by contrast between lines that describe a culturally expected sequence ( **a** 's: 211, 212, 213) and one that breaks that sequence with an unexpected intrusion ( **b** : 214 - like the ripening millet sequence in Kaitaba).

215-217: stanza in **aab** formed by contrast between lines that repeat "what" + "alarm" ( **a** 's: 215, 216 - reversed word order in the latter) and a single line that repeats "alarm" but embeds it in a different sentence ( **b** : 217).

They said, "The Chew-you-up troop went to hunt at dawn.
Perhaps they've killed an otter."
He said, "I'd be hearing ' *Big-cheeks*. '"
He said, "I'd be hearing the hunter's roar."
"Perhaps they've killed a waterbuck
He said, "I'd be hearing ' *Rustling*,'
I would be hearing, ' *Pisser-in-the-marsh*,'
That is, *'Worn-by-the-beautiful'*
I would have heard *'Destroyed-by-the-ugly'*
And *'Worn-by-the-beautiful.'"*

A wailing cry, a wailing cry
A wailing cry came in the door.
One said, "They must have killed a waterbuck there,
*Worn by the beautiful*. "

The wailing cry did not leave off, the wailing cry...
"They might have killed a mongoose there."
I'd be hearing ' *Apportioner-of-trails*. '
I would be hearing ' *Sounds-of-an-enanga*. '"

"They might have killed an omunyima there."
I'd be hearing ' *Lowing-like-a-mother-cow*.'
I'd be hearing
*'Anus-that-has-a-hoe-and-a-hafted-knife-inside'* "

"They might have killed an olutoni there."
"I'd be hearing ' *Spread-himself-with-spots*,'
There'd be *'Smeared-himself-with-rank-odor*.' "

When the wailing cry did not let up, did not let up...
When the wailing cry of Muneko, of the wilderness...

Bahi, "Ekilakulya kihigile bwankya.
Lundi bakwitayo engonge."
Ahi,"Nakubaile nimpulila ' *Lwamatama*. '"
Ahi, "Nakubaile nimpulila ' *Fo k'amahinda* '"
"Lundi bakwitayo enjobe."
Ahi, "Nakuba nimpulila ' *Kibuguta*, '
Nakuba nimpulila ' *Nyamunyalila lshanga*, '
Lebani ' *Nyamwambalwa abalungi* '
Nakuba nimpulila *'Nyamwitwa ababi'*
Leba *'Nyamwambalwaabalungi.'"*

Endulu endulu
Endulu yataha ekihigi.
Ati,"Bakwitayo enjobe,
*Nyamwambalwa abalungi*. "

Endulu tiyalek' endulu...
"Bakwitayo eikombo."
Nakuba nimpulila ' *Lwamagabe*. '
Nakuba nimpulila ' *Bilimu lw'enanga*. '"

"Bakwitayo omunyima."
Nakuba nimpulila ' *Ebijumilo nk' enzaile*. '
Nakuhulila ' *Kihende kilimu enfuka n' omuholo*. '"

"Bakwitayo olutoni."
"Nakuba nimpulila ' *Lwesigilentoijo*, '
Kulinya leba ' *Lwelagaize eminaami*. '"

Olw' endulu tiyaleka tiyaleka...
Olw' endulu eya Muneko eya ilungu...

NOTES

218-241 Big-cheeks, Hunter's roar, Rustling (like the sound of new fabric), Pisser-in-the-marsh, Worn-by-the-beautiful (referring to the hide), and others are praisenames for the animals whose pursuit in hunting is proposed as the possible origin of the puzzling cry. These epithets would be shouted when such animals are killed. Praise of the slain animal amplifies the hunter's identity, as in *Kajango* : 80.1-83.1. The Apportioner-of-trails (234) confuses hunting dogs by continually backtracking, giving each dog a different trail to follow. The *omunyima* , a hyrax, is said to low like a mother cow - a praise that notes the difference created by motherhood (see also *Kajango* : 332). The bard elaborates the episode by quoting courtiers' attempts to interpret the unsettling cries. Hunters' chants (and their absence) become evidence to evaluate alternate hypotheses.

POETIC STANZAS

219-227: two stanzas based on an **abb** pattern formed by contrast between lines composed as "perhaps they killed" + animal name ( **a** 's) and lines composed as "I would have heard" + animal praisename ( **b** 's); the first stanza (218-221) is formed in x **abb** by the use of an introductory line (218) followed by a line composed as **a** (219), followed by two **b** 's (220, 221); in the second stanza (222-227), the **abb** pattern is formed by one line composed as **a** (222), followed by a line composed as **b** (223), followed by an expansion of the expected, final **b** into a four line stanza in **abab** formed by contrast between lines composed as "I would have heard" + praisename ( **a** 's: 224, 226) and slightly different lines that are substantial repetitions of each other ( **b** 's: 225, 227).

228-241: verse passage of four linegroups (228-231, 232-235, 236-238, 239-241) formed in **aabb** by contrast between the linegroups composed as "alarm" / "they might have killed" + animal/ ["I would have heard" +] animal praisename ( **a** 's:228-231, 232-235; in the former, the first line is expanded to two lines; in the latter, the last line is so expanded) and the linegroups composed similarly but lacking the first compositional unit, "alarm"/, and expanding the final line to two ( **b** 's: 236-238, 239-241).

PLOT OUTLINE

**Lines 244-61:**
Finally, a cowherd arrives and with great emotion reports a cattle raid to the king.

**Lines 262-282:**
The king responds, recognizing the truth of the prophecy by repeating part of it. Then the cowherd reports the results of an attack on several villages.

NOTES

250-254 This same rhetorical figure, a species of adynaton, was used by the spirit medium to castigate his wife (33-37). Imaginary, hyperbolic violence proclaim the virtues that impel the speaker. A passion for knowledge of the unseen world drives the spirit medium to envision violence to his beloved new bride. The cowherd's love of cattle impels him to speak of violence even to so strong and dangerous a king as Kitekele. News of the unseen and love of cattle (the first subordinate to the second) motivate and frame the two principal narrative sequences.

250-51 Kabushumba and Kaitaba are Kitekele's sons (see *Kaitaba* : 376) as, it seems, is Kagambi.

255-256 Gentle-feet is a praisename for calfs, while sorghum tassels evoke the tufted tails of cattle (257).

262-263 Details about the king's beer and its container mark the importance of beer in the royal court (see also *Kajango* :358-370, *Kachwenyanja* :66-71, *Kaitaba* :80-89). Here the king's use of beer signals his transition from peaceful repose to warlike action.

266.1 1 Milk vessels are powerful symbols of household wealth and status, carefully carved, decorated and cared for. They honor a family head who has the social standing to possess cattle - here the king himself, the ultimate owner of all cattle. In their customary position at the hearth, they embody domesticity and well-being. Milk vessels are also images of brides, sent with them on their journies to their new families, wrapped with pure-white papyrus strands and attached to their permanent storage poles (see *Kaiyula* : 270-271.

POETIC STANZAS

244-254: compound stanza in **aab** formed by two five-line linegroups ( **a** 's: 244-248 and 249-253) contrasted with a final line of great thematic significance ( **b** : 254); both initial linegroups are composed internally as **abb** by contrast between single lines composed as "when" + past perfect verb... ( **a** 's: 244 and 249) and couplets that cohere internally by repetition and parallelism ( **b** 's: 245-246, 247-248 and 250-251, 252-253).

255-261: verse of two stanzas in **aab** formed by contrast between multiple lines that refer to the theft of cattle in general or in specific ( **a** 's: 255-256 and 258-260) and single lines that contain a synecdochic description of the disappearing cattle ( **b** 's: 257 and 261)

262-268: compound stanza, 3 + 3 + 2 , formed in **aab** by contrast between triplets whose lines cohere internally by stanzaic patterning ( **a** 's: 262-264, 265-266.1) and a couplet whose lines cohere by parallel use of a final prepositional phrase ( **b** : 267-268); triplets are formed respectively as **aab** and **aba** by contrast between multiple lines that cohere by repetition and/or parallelism ( **a** 's:262, 263 and 265,267) and single lines that both contain "What shall I do?" ( **b** 's: 264 and 266).

When he had come,
He said, "Where is Kitekele?"
He said, "Where is Kitekele?"
They said, "In the luchwamba grove. He's playing mankala."
They said, "In the luchwamba grove. He's playing mankala."
When he had cast his eyes on him,
He said, "If you'd have been *Flows-over-borders*,
If you'd have been Kabushumba Itimba,
Or your own Kaitaba,
Or Kagambi,
That mankala game I'd have thrown at you.

They are plundered, *the Gentle-footed ones!*
*The Sorghum tassels* , Provider.
I tell you this O King we see only their tufted tails.

Your favorite calf, the one to whom you gave the special pasture,
My lord, the one to whom you gave the special pasture at Kijongo,
They drove it away at the rear of the herd.
As it scampered off, its neck bells loosely jangled."

I saw this come upon the king as he was sipping, swallowing.
I saw them tilt the royal calabash back.
I heard him say, "What shall I do?"
He said, "The fellow has not plundered cattle!
What shall I do, my lord?
He's chopped apart the wooden vessels of our hearth!"
He said, "He camped on Cowrie Mountain
And came striding along to Kyabagenzi."

Olwo yakasingile akyaija...
Ahi,"Kitekele aliya?"
Ahi,"Kitekele aliya?"
Bati, "Ali omu luchwamba nayesha olwesho

Bati, "Ali omu luchwamba nayesha olwesho

Olwo yakamutaileho amaisho,
Ahi,"Kuba waba oli *Njolombi lubibi*,
Oli *Kabushumba Itimba* ,
Angili Kaitaba akawe,
Angili Kagambi,
Olwesho olu nakuba nalukusangwize.

Zanyagwa *Bilenge byoloba!*
*Ekikumba wa lgogo* Lugaba,
Ningila nti, Mukama, zakwoleka ekishusha.

Olunyana lwawe olwo wagisize,

Waitu, olwo wagisize Kijongo,

Balutemaho ekibunu.
Kalwailuka, amayugi galegeya."

Nkabona akashangwa nanywa namila.

Nkabona enkologo bainunula.
Nkahulila ahi, "Ngile ntai?"
Ati,"Omushaija tiyanyag' ente ezi!
Ningila nti, waitu?
Yantemela ekyanzi!"
Ati, "Atekeile omu Gwensimbi.
Nagalanjuka kwija omu Kyabagenzi."

PLOT OUTLINE

**Lines 283-294:**
The king responds first with emotion then with heroic gestures that foretell action.

**Lines 295-325:**
The king prepares for battle first by consulting diviners. Then he gives orders to household servants to prepare provisions.

NOTES

287-294 Striking poses, enacting gestures that embody royal virtues of strength and virility seems to have been a notable part of the discourse of the royal court (see *Kaitaba* : 252-255).

295 These doctors, or *bafumu* , are specialists in augury, in reading signs of events that are occurring elsewhere or that have not yet occurred. They are also specialists in the offensive and defensive use of magical charms. When possible, the names of *bafumu* are translated because they seem to have more clear and unusual meanings than other personal names.

POETIC STANZAS

269-282: compound stanza - of couplets composed as placename/ verb phrase - formed in **aba** by linegroups of couplets whose verb phrase contains "proclaims itself in flames" ( **a** 's: 269-274 and 279-282) contrasted with a linegroup whose verb phrase does not indicate destruction ( **b** : 275-278).

283-286: stanza in **ab** b **a'** formed by contrast between lines of quoted speech that begin, "He said, 'What shall I do...'" ( **a** 's: 283, 286) and lines of narrative that are composed solely of verbs ( **b** 's: 284, 285).

287-294: compound stanza of couplets composed as dependent verb + body part/ 2nd person locutive + sentence, in which the second line describes a visual metaphor for the image contained in the first; the compound stanza is formed in **aa** a **b** by contrast between couplets whose second line begins with a locutive ( **a** 's: 287-288, 289-290, 291-292) and a couplet that lacks the locutive and appends "king" the the end of the preceding line ( **b** : 293-294).

| | |
|---|---|
| | He said, "I tell you Bugengele of Nyawela" |
| 270 | He said, "I saw, proclaims itself in flames." |
| | He said, "Musila of Luhungu" |
| | He said, "as well, proclaims itself in flames." |
| | He said, "Ngalama of Kabi" |
| | He said, "my lord, proclaims itself in flames." |
| 275 | He said, "But in Kishogo of Lushu" |
| | He said, "he honored (your steward) Eishamba." |
| | He said, "Kishogo of Kayango |
| | He left untouched, desiring it for his own. |
| | Ntobola and Bikiga |
| 280 | My lord, those both proclaim themselves in flames. |
| | Bugengele of Nyawela |
| | As well, proclaims itself in flames." |
| | |
| | He said, "What shall I do, my men?" |
| | This came upon the king as he was sipping, swallowing. |
| 285 | But when he unblinked his eyes, see! They'd reddened. |
| | He said, "What shall I do?" the king. |
| | |
| | When he put out his chest, |
| | You'd say maidens put out milk vessel caps. |
| | When he showed his buttock, |
| 290 | You'd say it looked like a smooth, hard, sun-drying place. |
| | When he stood, and backs of knees appeared, |
| | You'd say a roof-peak dipped. |
| | When he shook his hair, the king, |
| | It looked like waving *yojwe* grass. |
| | |
| 295 | He said, "Call those doctors of mine." |
| | They summoned Busy-are-they |
| | They summoned Trial-maker and Abandoned-one. |
| | |
| | He said, "Do that water oracle of mine." |
| | They said, "Stir up the oracle of Kitulu. |

| | |
|---|---|
| | Ahi, "Nkugambile Bugengele bwa Nyawela" |
| 270 | Ahi,"nasiga nelangwa akalilo." |
| | Ahi, "Musila kya Luhungu" |
| | Ahi, "nayonene nelangwa akalilo." |
| | Ahi, "Ngalama ya Kabi aha" |
| | Ahi, "Waitu nelangwa akalilo." |
| 275 | Ahi,"Kishogo ekya Lushu" |
| | Ati, "omwo yakunilamu Eishamba." |
| | Ahi, "Kishogo ekya Kayango |
| | Yagisigilaho okugyegomba. |
| | Ntobola na Bikiga |
| 280 | Waitu, ebyo nibilangwa akalilo. |
| | Bugengele bwa Nyawela |
| | Na wenene nelangwa akalilo." |
| | |
| | Ahi, "Ngilenta bashaija bange?" |
| | Akashangwa nanywa namila. |
| 285 | Kayambululile leba gatukula. |
| | Ahi, "Ngilenta?" wenene omukama. |
| | |
| | Kayatuna ati ekifuba, |
| | Ohi baisiki batuna emyeye. |
| | Kayayoleka ati ekinyugunyu, |
| 290 | Ohizashana enyano z' omutabo. |
| | Kayayemelea entege, |
| | Oti lushwi lwabonda. |
| | Kayatengya eishoke omukama, |
| | Enshombesa lyamushana eyojwe. |
| | |
| 295 | Ahi,"Nyetela abafumu bange abo." |
| | Bamweta Batagaitila |
| | Bamweta Anyanyia na Kalugwa. |
| | |
| | Ahi, "Kola omu mpayula zange ezo." |
| | Bahi, "Ijulunga empayula lwa Kitulu. |

295-297: stanza in **abb** formed by contrast between narrative lines composed as "they called" + personal name ( **b** 's: 296-297) and a single line of quoted speech ( **a** : 295).

NOTES

299.1 Bwelanyange is the site of a famous spirit shrine.

308.1 This line was inserted at the request of the singer.

309-321 Those addressed on these lines are apparently servants. Their names have the following meanings: Telikunda (309) "Never gives in," Byabato (309) "Children's matters" (311)

317-319 This allusive, riddle-like name used in address, May-it-not-find-me, together with its answer, The-eye-of-a-hateful-one, marks the addressee as a *muzana* , a female slave. This call-and-response sequence is like that which names the muzana in Kachwenyanja: 188-188.1. The order to bind charms indicates that she is one of the King's mistresses.

POETIC STANZAS

304-306: stanza in **abb** formed by contrast between lines composed as ...3rd person verb + direct object ( **b** 's: 305, 306) and a single line composed of three verbs ( **a** : 304).

307-308: stanza in **abb** formed by contrast between lines that contain "sound" + "drums" ( **b** 's: 307.1-308, order reversed in the second) and a single formulaic line ( **a** : 307).

309-319: compound stanza, 2 + 2 + 2 + 2 + 3, formed in **aa** aa **b** by couplets composed as personal name(s)/..."you bind up provisions" ( **a** 's: 309-310, 311-312, 313-314, 315-316) contrasted with three lines ( **b** : 317-319) that begin similarly, but vary the established pattern.

320-324: stanza in **aabb** b formed by contrast between lines composed as "he summoned" + personal name ( **a** 's: 320-321) and lines that begin with a locutive ( **b** 's:322-324).

It comes from Bwelanyange.

Speak, speak.
Speak the words of Little-doctor and of Charcoal,
And of Blood, *Preventer-of-things-to-come* .
Speak. Say, 'This is the way we shall raid.'"

When they consulted it, it answered yes.
They saw him burn Kihanja.
That day lo! He left it bare earth.

He said, "What can I do, child?
Sound the drums."
[Drums sounded in reverberating roar.]

I heard him call Never-gives-in of Byabato.
He said, "See that you bind up provisions.
And you, Didn't-I-tell-them-so Kitano,
And see that you bind up provisions.
And you Milk-vessel-cap of Speared-one,"
He said, "and you bind up provisions.
Lyakanazi and Lulongo,"
He said, "and see that you bind up provisions.
Child, Child Not-like-a-bad-debt,"
She answered, "My lord, The-eye-of-a-hateful-one."
He said, "Bind up charms on your waist. I go to war."

He summoned Mushumbusi Ndiita.
He summoned Kikanya Kagondo.
He said, "You as well, my men,"
He said, "Guard my things."
He said, "I go to war I cannot shrink from it."

Zikaluga Bwelanyange.

Gamba gamba.
Gamba ekya Kafumu na Kakala,
Na Shagama *Omwangwa-kilija* .
Gamba oti, 'Leba okwo tulatabala.'"

Kabatamu zeleba zaikiliza.
Babona yagyokya Kihanja.
Kil' ekyo leba yagisiga enkuuto.

Ahi, "Ngile ntai, bojo?
Lahya ngoma."
[Engoma balahya zakuhuna].

Nkahulila ati Telikunda ya Byabato.
Ati,"Leba yekomy' enkolongo.
Na iwe Timbagambile Kitano,
Na iwe leba yekomy' enkolongo.
Na iwe Mweya gwa Luchumitwa,"
Ahi, "na iwe yekomy' enkolongo.
Lyakanazi na Lulongo,"
Ahi, "na iwe leba yekomy' enkolongo.
Bojo Bojo Tiliba-ngobya,"
Ahi, "Waitu, elisho ly' omunobi."
Ahi, "Yekomy' empumbya natabala."

Yabilikila Mushumbusi Ndiita.
Yabilikila Kikanya Kagondo.
Ahi, "Na inywe bojo bashaija,"
Ahi, "Mulandindil' ebintu."
Ahi, "Natabala tinkyosha."

PLOT OUTLINE

**Lines 326-50:**
The warriors present at court chant their self-praise to prepare for battle.

**Lines 351-377:**
The king sets out. He pauses to comment on some monkeys as symbols of the ruling dynasties of other kingdoms Another warrior chants his praise.

NOTES

326-350 This self praise ( *ebyebugo* ) was recited extemporaneously by a member of the audience. The bard continues to play the enanga, but the reciter chants seemingly without regard to its melody. The recitation occurs within the frame of the depicted events: with this genre warriors encouraged and identified themselves in preparation for battle. The imagery of snakes, healing, and spirits is probably connected to reciter's calling as a mufumu (plural, bafumu; see above, line 295). But this is not the reciter's personal self-praise per se; it is rather a performance done to support and augment the ballad of *Kitekele* .

328-329 What climbs a tree with no fingers or claws is a snake (below, 339-342).

333 Crow also appears as a principal character in the spirit world in *Kajango* , line 354.

342 Kashasila, "She-who-feels-another's-pain," is the spirit connected with the reciter's clan, Balwani of Kyamtwala. She is one of the spirits who assisted him in his practice as a *mufumu* .

348 At Buzongola, "Place of travelers," grew a tree sacred to Wamala, king of the Bachwezi, according to a version of the epic Muhata - another association between the speaker and the spirit world.

349 The king might be addressed as Father-creator for his decisive role in creating material well being (see *Kaitaba* : 4-5).

350 These spears refers figuratively to warriors gathered for battle (see also *Kachwenyanja* 54ff) and literally to the actual spears brandished when warriors would recite their self praises.

353 The Bakulwa clan in Kyamutwala were the preparers of the chief's coffee (Cory and Hartnoll). On the social and ritual uses of coffee, see *Kajango* : 54n, 433n, and 435n.

I heard the drums roar with a will.
Self Praise Recitation Begins
*I am the Impaler, the Wound-that-never-heals.*
*I attack lurching and reeling like One-full-of-wrath.*

*I climbed a tree*
*But have no fingers or claws.*

*Father was ill, and they said, 'You'll not inherit.'*
*That's why I came for directions to a healer.*
*They said, 'He's at Ntoija. I descended to Bukongo.*
*That's when I came to Crow.*
*Crow brought meat and gave it to me.*
*He took it from an open grave.*
*He said, 'Go, give it to your father, be he well.'*
*That's why I came.*
*When I came I spread it on him.*

*I am a wooden crook.*
*I am an adder.*
*I am Moves-nervously-watching.*
*I am She-who-feels-another's-pain of Makes-certain.*

*I went to Uganda.*
*They bent me over and found hair filling an anus.*

*I came and killed a Ganda.*
*The Ganda they dispose of.*
*They say, 'Where does that one come from?'*
*They say, 'He comes from Place-of-Journeyers.'*

*Shine forth Father creator .*
*These spears are yours .*
Self-Praise Poetry ends
I heard the king as he reached his palace roadway,
roadway, roadway,
He said, "I'll descend at Nzilonke.
I'll tread the house lane of the Bakulwa."
They said, "My lord, pass by Kyakahunga.
Go and reach the house lane of the Bakulwa.

POETIC STANZAS

351-355: compound stanza in **abb** , 1 + 2 + 2, formed by couplets composed as subjunctive verb + placename/ subjunctive verb(s) + "house lane of the Bakulwa" ( **b** 's: 351.1-352, 354-355) contrasted with

Nkahulila zalaha zakunda.
Self-Praise Poetry
*Ninye Achumit' Ensheshe.*
*Ndwana ninkweya nka Mugambaizi.*

Nkakuba omuti
Tingil' ebyala na mpambo.

*Tata yalwala bati, 'Tolilyabye.'*
*Nikwo kwija kundagila omutambi.*
*Bati, 'Ali Ntoija. Nasoka Bukongo.*
*Nilwo nagile nagobela Ekikona.*
*Ekikona kyaleta enyama kyagimpa.*
*Kyagihya omu kina ky' enyanga.*
*Kiti, 'Ogende ohe isho akile.'*
*Nikwo kwija.*
*Olwo naizile tata nkagumusiga.*

*Inye nkoloboizo.*
*Mba mpili.*
*Ninye Nshamangi.*
*Ninye Kashasila ka Lwaiziliga.*

*Nkagya Buganda.*
*Bankunamya bashanga byoya nibijwila luhende.*

*Naija naitamu Omuganda.*
*Omuganda nibamukambula.*
*Bati, 'Omuntu ogu yalug'ahai?'*
*Bahi, 'Yaluga Buzongola.'*

*Habuka Ishowanga.*
*Agawe ngago.*
Self-Praise Poetry ends
Nkahulila kayagobile nyalulembo nyalulembo nyalulembo,

Ahi, "Nsongokele Nzilonke.
Ntembuke omu ilembo ly' Abakulwa."
Bati, "Waitu, olabe Kyakahunga
Ogyeogobe omu ilembo ly' Abakulwa.

a single line marked by aside, adverbial past perfect verb, and repetition ( **a** : 351).

PLOT OUTLINE

**Lines 378-395:**
The king summons particular warriors and names the battalions each should serve with.

NOTES

358-365 Monkey is the primary totem of the ruling Hinda clan. Claiming to be a (maternal) grandchild justifies Kitekele's joking and refers to his marriage to a Hinda woman. A man customarily joked with his grandparents and preferably married a woman of his grandmother's clan.

366-377 This self praise is recited by the same member of the audience who recited before. In it, he assumes the persona of Ngimbwa (literally, "He who is compelled"). A close friend of the singer, the reciter apparently takes the character from another of Abdullah Feza's pieces, *Kaitaba* . Thus do *Kitelele* : 367-368 resemble *Kaitaba* 131-132 and *Kitekele* : 374-375.1 resemble *Kaitaba* 132-134.

379 382: The unclean tasks and unspeakable words are acts of sorcery performed on the king's behalf by royal sorcerers ( *bafumu* ).

POETIC STANZAS

356-358: stanza in **aab** formed by contrast between lines that comprise dependent clauses ( **a** 's:356-357) and a single line that comprises the main clause ( **b** : 358).

359-365: compound stanza in **aa** a **b** , 2 + 2 + 2 + 1, formed by contrast between couplets that cohere by repetition and/or semantic association ( **a** 's: 359-360, 361-362, 363-364) and a single line that completes the logic of the passage.

When he entered the house lane of the Bakulwa at Kayanga, Kayanga,
Suddenly he glanced into a tree, into a mushasha tree.
Lo! He saw a monkey.

He said, "Child with blackest black lips,"
He said, "The Hinda are burning their plantains!"
He said, "Yo-yo-yo-yo," he said, "so, they've straightened their tails.
Like spearshafts, they've straightened them well!"
They said, "My lord, don't joke with a monkey."
He said, "And why should I not joke?
Among Hinda women I'm a grandchild."
Self Praise Recitation Begins
*I am Foiler, child of Essential-warrior*
*Obliged-one, Bad-dream, child of Causer-of-retreats*
*An Ancient Feud.*
*You see I fought in far off lands.*
*I raided in Zinzaland, then raided in Bunyoro.*
*I killed a man there.*
*I raided in Buganda of Ntege at the home of Junju.*
*And at the home of They-don't-let-me-be I killed a man.*
*An ancient feud placed a scar on my eye.*
*I am of Bushalita and the Decider-of-cases,*

*What-holds-you-in-its-grasp.*

*Go regally, Father creator.*
*These spears are yours .*

Self-Praise Poetry ends

I heard him summon Foiler child of Essential-warrior.
He said, "Do these unclean tasks."
"One's king does not despise him for them."

*" Eyes Redden in Anger,*
*Little-scourge, I dwelled among*
*Speakers-of-the-unspeakable,"*

Kayagobile omu ilembo ly' Abakulwa bonene Kayanga, Kayanga,
Kayachwile kuleba ati omu muti omu mushasha,
Leba yabona enkende.

Ati, "Bojo ebinwa sisisi"
Ati,"Abahinda nibokya ebitoke!"
Ahi," Yo-yo-yo-yo," ahi, "nka zagolola emikila.

Nk' emango zagolola kulungi!"
Bati, " Waitu, otasilibya nkende."
Ahi, "Ntaisilibye mbeki?
Manti omu bahindakazi inye ndi mwijukulu."
Self-Praise Poetry
*Inye ninye Butabile bwa Nyamulwana*
*Ngimbwa Ihunga lya Makuba*
*Obulwano bw' eila.*
*Nobona nkalwana amahanga.*
*Nkatabala Buzinja. Nagya natabala Bunyolo.*
*Nkaitamu omuntu.*
*Natabala Buganda bwa Ntege omwa Junju.*
*Omwa Tibandeka nagya naitamu omuntu.*
*Obulwana bw' eila bwankoza enkojo aha lisho.*
*Ndi wa Bushalita na Muchwampaka,*

*Ekyokukwata.*

*Wehinde Ishowanga.*
*Amachumu ngago gawe.*

Self-Praise Poetry ends

Nkahulila abilikila Butabile bwa Nyamulwana.
Ati, "Okol' ebitanju."
"Mukamawe atabimutamilwa."

*" Kyezigil'amaisho,*
*Kati ntwile nambahemwile,"*

PLOT OUTLINE

**Lines 396-419:**
The king attacks Kihanja kingdom. Scenes of battle are described. The army moves on and the king orders particular villages attacked.

NOTES

383-395 The troops of warriors named and praised were recruited on a geographical basis. The Self-Invited is a euphemism for death - in most people's experience, he is not summoned, but comes anyway. Shield-breakers is the praisename for residents of Bugabo kingdom, whose King was Nkwele (393).

393-395 Fluid movement in Nkwele's praise (393) refers to the Hinda origin of this first king of Bugabo. A mulamula tree was used to mark boundaries (Cory 116) and has a mythical charter for doing so (Schmidt 116).

398 A Muhamba is a native of Kihanja kingdom

399 *Babwiko* is said to be a term of address in Ihangiro regional speech

403 Involuntary urination occurs as a result of being struck by an arrow.

404 This utterance about *tonjotonjo* wood seems to express a mistaken belief in invulnerability, like Macbeth's confidence inspired by the prophecy about Birnham wood.

POETIC STANZAS

383-386: stanza in **aa** a **b** contrast between lines composed as "go with" + battalion name ( **a** 's: 383, 384, 385) and a single line composed as double verb + prepositional phrase ( **b** : 386).

388-395: stanza in **aba** a **b** bbbb formed by contrast between lines composed as "go with" + battalion name ( **a** 's: 388, 390, 391) and lines comprised of praisenames ( **b** 's: 389, 391.1, 392, 393, 394, 395). intro line

399-404: compound stanza in **aba** formed by contrast between couplets whose lines cohere by their initial exclamation ( **a** 's: 399-400, 401-402) and a couplet whose lines cohere by a repeated verb stem ( **b** : 401-402).

He said, "Go with the Mulalamba troop *The-Routers*,
*The-Routers*.
Go with the Eaters-of-the-clash-of-battle troop.
Go with the *Soft-Spoken* Muziba.
Travel by the ford at Kyenyabasa."

He summoned *Causer-of-retreats* Obliged-one.
He said, "Go with the Mirth-makers troop,
*I make him merry who made merry the Self-Invited*. "
He said, "Go with the Eaters-of-the-clash-of-battle troop.
Go with the Shield-breakers,
*Who ate the quail of Buyenje*,
*People of the Hima Tologo*,
*Men of Nkwele, who moves like waving swampgrass*, "
*Mulamula tree fears the boundaries*,
*Feeder of calves that wanted to return home and play*.

He said, "Descend,
At Kalebe we descend upon them."

I heard a Muhamba.

"Hey Babwiko!"
"Hey Babwiko!"
"Did you hear?" "We heard the royal drums."
"Listen they're sounding."
Hey! Let them come. Our bows will make them piss."
"Hey! They can't touch us with tonjotonjo wood from Black Forest."

[audience Here's a hunting horn (imitating) tulo tulo tulo tulo --
You hear the Muhyoza.]

I heard someone say, "Yo yo yo yo He's hit you!"
He asked, "What's he hit me with?"
"Tonjotonjo wood from Black Forest."

407-409: stanza in **aab** formed by contrast between lines that share a verb stem ( **a** 's: 407-408) and a single line that repeats part of the final line of the preceding figure ( **b** : 409)

Ati, "Ogende n' Omulalamba *Nyakabinga*, *Nyakabinga*.

Ogende n' Omulyampulo.
Ogende n' Omuziba *Njegu*.
Mugye mulabe ogwa Kyenyabasa."

Akabikila *Makuba* Ngimbwa.
Ati, "Ogende n' Omushekya,
*Nshekya abashekize Lukila lwa Mbeta*. "
Ati, "Ogende n' Omulyampulo.
Ogende n' Omuhenda-ngabo,
*Abalileendai y' Obuyenje*,
*Abakyaluhima Tologo*,
*Abashaija ba Nkwele, Lulengeija nabago*,
*Mulamula gutina ekihanyia*,
*Nyamulisiliza enyana ikagonza kutaha kuzana*.

Ati, "Osongoke,
Ogwa Kalebe tubasongokele."

Nkahulila Omuhamba.

"Heh Babwiko!"
"Heh Babwiko!"
"Mwahulile?" "Twahulile enkoito."
"Hula zalaha."
"Heh! Kaije. Tubanyaze obute."
"Heh! Tibakukoza mutonjotonjo gwa Lwasina."

(Naija kuleta akakuli tulo tulo tulo tulo--

Mwahulil' Omuhyoza.)

Nkabona ati, "Yoi yoi yoi yoi yakulasha!"
Ahi, "Yandasa kahi?"
"Omutonjotonjo gwa Lwasina."

PLOT OUTLINE

**Lines 421-460:**
After victorious battle, several warriors chant their self-praise.

NOTES

415 He said refers to Kitekele.

419 Slaughter Mountain was the site where King Kalemera, the fourth Hinda king of Kyamutwala, created a stream from the summit to the base of the mountain with the blood of humans and cattle (Kaindoa in Schmidt 299, Cory 53-54)

423 Mr. Kataishi, one of those gathered to listen to the performance, was introduced as a member of the royal clan (Bankango) and closely related to the line of kings.

427 A Muyoza is a native of Kyamutwala kingdom.

He said, "Let's retreat, child,
See, your brother lies fallen in lugunga grass."
He said, "Didn't I tell you so? They've surrounded them."

Iyo-o they crossed over.
When they'd crossed at Kyenyabasa,
They climbed up at Muhutwe.

He said, "That village there, have them cut it to the ground."
I saw them cut the village to the ground.
They said, "That way is too far, Bahyoza."
When they came to Ibwela, I saw they cut, and the earth reddened.
At Slaughter Mountain they cut, and the earth reddened.
And they followed on to Kabilizi, and it reddened.

In Ikunyu I saw...

Listen!
(audience Bespeak yourself, recite your praise--)

Self Praise Recitation Begins

*I speak to you, I chant my praise, I am Kataishi.*
*Travelling, I am Never-climbed-upon.*
*I am The-Abrasive-one.*
*Yes indeed, you chant your praise, you chant your praise.*
*A Muhyoza chants his praise and brings it out from inside.*
*He straightened his back, the Child-of-the-Angry-one, the Muhyoza.*
*He said, 'Chant your praise - Let me hear what you say.'*
*I leave off."*

Another Self Praise Recitation Begins

Ahi,"Katusingwa bojo.
Nobona mulumuna wawe yegama omu lugunga."
Ati, "Tinakugambila nti babanzongoka."

Iyo-o bashabuka.
Kabashabukile Kyenyabasa,
Batemba omuli Muhutwe.

Ati,"Eki kyalo kyonene bakitema."

Nkabona batem' ekyalo.
Bati, "Okw' ali alai Omuhyoza."
Kabaija omuli Ibwela nkabona batema lyatukula.

Bagango batema lyatukula.
Na Kabilizi bahondela lyatukula.

Omuli Ikunyu mwonene nkabona...

Hula!
(Yegambisilize yebuge--)

Self-Praise Poetry

*Ninkugambila ninyebuga 'nye Kataishi.*
*Nagenda ninye Tintelembwa.*
*Ninsomola aho.*
*Inya wewe webuge webuge*
*Muhyoza yayebugaya yekologota.*
*Yagya yashutula Lwaijumba Omuhyoza.*

*Ahi, 'Webuge mpulile ebigambo byanyu ebyomulagamba.'*
*Nalekela."*

Self-Praise Poetry

PLOT OUTLINE

**Lines 461-497:**

The army travels further into Kihanja, attacks other settlements, and crosses into Ihangiro Kingdom. Another scene of men in battle is described.

NOTES

431-460 This self praise was performed by the singer himself

432-435 These lines resemble the description of a character in *Kaitaba* : 130-135.

443 Butono, here a proper name, as a common noun refers to an infant from the age of three months to the time it begins to walk.

447 In traditional belief, a latent fetus is one that has been conceived by intercourse but lies dormant for months without developing. This is consistent with the traditional ritual practice of *bisisi* , through which a dead man could be said to have fathered a child with his widow more than nine months after his death, thereby gaining a male heir and avoiding the loss of property from the father's line.

He said, " *I am Banana-stumps, Child of Afflictions.*
*I-am-compelled, Bad-dream of the Causer-of-Retreats.*
*An Ancient feud has fixed a scar upon my eye.*
*I am of Bucha and the Decider-of-cases*
*A child of a Muyego wife, I come from Long-necked Giraffe.*
*I come from Katoma of Mileego*
*Where warriors purchase cattle.*
*I am of the Father of Rocky-outcroppings,*
*Kahima Malima of Igogo in Kigalama of Ntahi.*
*A large and beautiful forest.*
*I come from Wet-one, Things-overhanging. I am ruled by Kagege forest.*
*Let me tell you so you'll know I am the child of warriors.*
*I am the child of Amri Binamungu*
*Whom they call Ta Butono.*
*I am the child of Munabi Gusitini.*
*I praise where I was born!*
*Father and mother.*
*Those two. Mother did not come with a latent fetus in her belly.*
*I was born in Kitendagulo of Nyawela.*
*In a small village that has no stones.*
*Miziku bush I come from nkeke grass.*
*I was cut from It-will-not-set.*
*I am a child of the Path-through-swamps.*
*Good watering places I tell you.*
*I come from Kilombe.*
Kanyamuli
*Of Lukoko river.*
*Kakindo village*
*I am child of Kyanyalwela*
*I am not one who hides himself .*
*Conquer Provider.*

Self-Praise Poetry ends

He did not ask another word.

Ahi," *Ninye Bikonya bwa Malwaile.*
*Ngimbwa Ihunga lya Makuba*
*Obulwano bweila bukankwasa enkoju aha lisho.*
*Mba wa Bucha na Buchwampaka*
*Ndi wa Mukayego nduga Lutwiga.*
*Nduga Katoma ka Mileego*
*Mbali emanzi egul' ente*
*Ndi w' ebyazi kyeishe,*
*Kahima Malima Kya Igogo Kigalama kya Ntahi.*
*Kibila kilungi.*
*Nduga Kishaba Ebihalaza. Ntwalwa Kagege.*

*Nkugambile kumanya ndimwana w' emanzi.*
*Ndi mwana wa Amri Binamungu*
*Owo beta Ta Butono.*
*Ndi mwana wa Munabi Gusitini.*
*Kanyebuge mbali nzalwa!*
*Tata na mawe.*
*Ababili tiyaizile nankongolo munda.*

*Nja nzalwa Kitendagulo kya Nyawela.*
*Omukalo katagila ibale.*
*Emiziku nduga nyaikeke.*
*Ntemwa Kyatiligwe.*
*Ndi mwana w'ebishambagilo.*
*Enchulo nung' inye nkugambile.*
*Nja nduga Kilombe.*
*Kanyamuli*
*Yo-o gwa Lukoko.*
*Kakindo*
*Ndi mwana wa Kyanyalwela*
*Inye tinakwesheleka.*
*Singa Lugaba.*

Self-Praise Poetry ends

Tiyabaliz' ekindi.

NOTES

478 The men of Buganguzi were infamous warriors ( *Kachwenyanja* : 184.1).

480 Banyaihangilo are denizens of Ihangilo kingdom.

492 The victorious denigrate the vanquished by referring to them with a diminutive, as the spirit medium did with his wives (22).

POETIC STANZAS

462-468: stanza in **aba** a **b** ab formed by contrast between lines composed as preposition + placename (462, 464, 465 (+ initial verb), 467) and lines composed as "...they cut and the earth reddened" ( **b** 's:463, 466, 468).

On Slaughter Mountain
I saw they cut and the earth reddened.
In Makongola
They climbed to Bushaka
And they cut and the earth reddened.
In Bushagala and Kamachumu
And they cut and the earth reddened.

When he looked toward Kamachumu he saw into Lwanda
And into Busingo.
He saw into Lutenge.
He said, "Go cut that village to the ground.
From there men came who killed my own men."

I saw At Busingo they cut and the earth reddened.
And Lwanda they cut, and the earth reddened.
Lutenge-e
I heard they cut, and the earth reddened.

When it reddened he stood at Lutenge and crowed.
He looked at Buganguzi, there at Nkungu's home.
He said, "Which village is that?"
They said, "It is Buganguzi, Nkungu's home."
He said, "From there come Banyaihangilo,
Killers of my men."

I heard them speak, the royal drums.
They spoke without cease.
I heard when men came rolling
Up a hill,
The Muhyoza, Sling-carrier
They shot him with an arrow in the knee.

All of them, Banyaihangilo of Mbatama village,
When the arrows began to fly among the leaves,
You'd think that children played at shooting reeds.
He who kneels to let his arrow fly
Finds Bahyoza split his crown.

They did not ask another word.
They said, "The little ones that run,"
They said, "we'll chop in two."
They went swiftly. It is they in Nshamba.
And there they cut, and the earth reddened.
In Ihangilo there
They say, "Let us respect the palace."

Omuli Magango mwonene
Nkabona batema yatukula.
Omuli Makongola
Batemba omuli Bushaka
Na bonene batema yatukula.
Omu Bushagala na Kamachumu
Na bonene batema yatukula.

Kayaleba ati Kamachumu yaija yabona omuli Lwanda
N'omuli Busingo.
Yabona n' omuli Lutenge
Ati, "Mugende mukiteme ekyalo ekyo.
Nikyo kyalugwamu abashaija b'okwita abashaija bange."

Nkabona Busingo batema yatukula.
Na Lwanda batema yatukula.
Lutenge-e
Nkahulila batema yatukula

Mh Kayatukula yayema ahali Lutenge yakokoloma.
Yabona honene Buganguzi omwa Nkungu.
Ati, "Ekyalo ekyo nikiha?"
Bati, "Ni Buganguzi omwa Nkungu."
Ahi,"Niyo halugile Abanyaihangilo,
Abalasile abashaija bange."

Nkahulila zagamba enkoito.
Zagamba tibaleka.
Nkahulila kayaizile kutolotomba
Kugy' eigulu,
Omuhyoza wenene Ngozi
Bamulalsha omwambi ogw' okugulu.

Bona Abanyaihangilo ba Mbatama,
Emihambi kelikulaba omu bishansha,
Oti bana mbazanisa emikenke.
Alikubandama kegy' eigulu
Asiga bonene bachw' enkombo.

Tibabaliz' ekindi.
Bati, "Obulaguluka,"
Bati, "obu tugutule."
Bailuka. Nibabo omuli Nshamba.
Ahana honene batema lyatukula.
Omuli Ihangilo mwonene
Bahi, "Tukunile ekikale."

PLOT OUTLINE

**Lines 498-518:**
The king of Ihangiro is heard to utter words of fear and awe for Kitekere and to order that tribute be paid him. Royal women of Ihangiro comment on Kitekere's manliness.

**Lines 519-536:**
Kitekere decides to stay temporarily in Ihangiro, receives tribute from the king there, and threatens further attack. His men counsel peace.

NOTES

499 Ntale means Lion.

513 Such-and-such ( *nanka* ) refers to the King's penis. The virility of the elder man is an important part of his identity.

I heard the Munyaihangilo,
King Ntale say, "Child
That Kabale king is a bad one.
He is the very lion of my name,
*An Ancient Boar, Makes-Hunters-Wary.*
*Child of Igalami and Bashaija,*
*Raiser-of-Howls in the early morning.*
*Great Man-climbing leopard of Kahigi,*
*Omwilu of Kainyombo and Nyaimoma,*
(aside that cigarette is bothering me)
*Calves that do not hinder, Thighs that do not shame.* "
He said, "Go and pay tribute to him.

The royal women say, "Our Lord!
Let's go and have a look. A Hima who kills Hinda?"

The Hinda women put on their leather aprons.
Himself had already become an old man.
The tip of his such-and-such had become a lighter red.
What eyes they fell upon him with!

"He-e" they said, "And the Hinda are fearful. The Hinda are fearful.
This old man?" They said, "Eh-eh-eh my dears!
One to be feared? Never!
Don't say such a thing, my lord."

Himself, he did not say, "I give respect to the King of Ihangilo."

When he arrived at Kashekela village,
He said, "Build here, construct."
They built, they constructed.
They paid tribute, they paid tribute.

Cattle came that day.
He said, "Slaughter these for Bahyoza to eat."
They brought others saying, "These are for your men."
They said," The king did not send Tse-tse-fly.
He has already gone by the road to Zinzaland."

Nkahulila wenene Omunyihangilo,
Ntale ati, "Bojo
Omukama wa Kabale ogu aba mubi.
Aba ntale nk' eibala lyange,
*Mpunu Nkulu lwa Kabakengya.*
*Lwa Igalami na Bashaija,*
*Lwa Mboigozi omutulankya,*
*Luhalatana empisi empango lwa Kahigi,*
*Omwilu wa Kainyombo na Nyaimoma,*
(esigara yanyita)
*Nfundo itamulema, Mabelo gatamugoola."*
Ahi, "Mugende mugye muhonge.

Abahindakazi bati, "He-eh Baitu
Tugende tulebe. Omuhima ogwo alikwita Abahinda aba?"

Bajwala Abahindakazi n' enkanda.
Wenene akaba yakuzile yabaile mugulusi.
Obunwa bwe nanka bwahyokile.
Ago bakamutaileho!

"He-eh N' ebihinda bitina. Bahende batina.

Ogwo ay'okuzile?" Ati, "He-he-he Babwiko!
W'okutina? leka!
Otakigamba, waitu."

Wenene tiyagil' ati, "Inye ninkunila omukama wa Ihangilo."

Kayahikile omu Kashekela mwonene,
Ahi, "Mujenge mwombeke."
Bajenga bayombeka.
Bahonga bahonga

Ente zaija kil' ekyo.
Ahi, "Mwiteme ezi za Bahyoza bazilye."
Balet' ezindi ahi, "Za bashaija bawe."
Ahi, "Wenene tabaile amutumile Kijuju.
Yagenzile ogwa Buzinja."

PLOT OUTLINE

**Lines 537-558:**
The army stays to harvest its millet and then returns home. The self-praise of victorious warriors is heard again.

NOTES

542-558 The reciter of this self praise also recited the passages on lines 326-350 and 366-378.

543-545 These images refer to the chicken - immunity from lightning and leg spurs - and are an allusion to the clan of the reciter's mother. The Basaizi of Kyamutwala had a chicken as a clan brother ( *mulumuna* ), or secondary totem.

He did not ask another word.
He said, "I'll till the earth and stay six months."
He said, "I'll see if he regains his strength
And frees his men to fight.
Rage I have much.
I might rise up and go attack the king of Zinzaland,
And of Kalagwe of Nono,
And of Rwanda of Mibale."
They said, "Accept settlement, O king.
Do not set kingdoms trading blows."

They built, they dwelled, they protected planted millet.
They harvest it and cook it into porridge.
He said, "Go and tell King Ntale,
Say, 'Do nothing else.
On this day he returns home.'"
Self Praise Recitation Begins
*I am She-who-feels-another's-pain of Makes-certain.*
*Thunder said, 'I'll strike you!*
*I said, 'You strike me? I am the*
*Grower-of-sharpened-points,*
*Iron hammers like a spirit medium's.*

*I come from Kibale of Katwenge.*
*I am of Iron things.*
*I am of two genitalia.*
*I come from Katembe and Mulongo.*
*I am of Igombe village. I am of Mankala-player. I am of Kagolo.*
*I am of Conqueror of Little-guardian, Old-wrinkled-one of the Bulls.*
*I came from Wanderer's home.*

*I am a child of the Balwani clan*
*Whose prohibition is black-spot cattle.*
*Their prohibition is not like other people's.*
*Their prohibition is not minnows.*
*Their prohibition is not this or that. Their prohibition is an entire cow.*
*And that's my prohibition too.*

*Hail, Father-creator, mount raids. We return home.*

Self-Praise Poetry ends

Tiyabaliz' ekindi.
Ahi, "Ningonza ndime male emyezi mukaga."
Ahi, "Ndebe nka yakwejumba
Akataishula abashaija tukalwana.
Ekiniga nyina king' inye.
Nakwemamu 'nye ngenda ntela omukama wa Buzinja,
Na Kalagwe ka Nono,
Na Rwanda lwa Mibale."
Bati, "Lamulwa mukama.
Amahang' otagatelanisa."

Bayombeka batula bayemela obulo.
Babugesha babugoya.
Ahi, "Mugye mugambile Ntale,
Muti, 'Mutaligila bigambo bindi.
Kilo kya mbwenu yaihulula.'"
Self-Praise Poetry
*Inye ninye Kashasila ka Bwaiziliga.*
*Enkuba eti, 'Nkutele!*
*Nti, 'Ontel' otai? Inye nkamela mashongolo,*

*Nyondo nk' embandwa.*

*Inye nzalwa nduga Kibale kya Katwenge.*
*Ndi w' ebyoma.*
*Ndi w' empali ibili.*
*Nduga Katembe na Mulongo.*
*Ndi wa Igombe.Ndi wa Kyeshe. Ndi wa Kagolo.*

*Ndi wa Misingo lw' Akalinda, Lukunjwa igulwalw' Enumi.*

*Nkalug' omwa Mitabuuko.*

*Ninye mwana wa Balwani*
*Abazizil' ente ya kinya*
*Tibazila bya bantu*
*Tibazila bukena.*
*Tibazila kiki Bakizil'ente yona.*

*Na 'nye niyo ndikuzila.*

*Habuka ishowanga tabala. Twaihulula.*

Self-Praise Poetry ends

PLOT OUTLINE

**Lines 559-566:**

In a coda, the singer comments on the punishment of the miscreant and envisions the descendants of Kitekere walking back to Kyamutwara Kingdom.

*Tse-tse-fly pecked up what would kill him.*
*It's true, the one to die pecks up what kills it.*
(You've played it! --)
Change in Melody
Push on,
Push on, children.
Push homeward *Flows-over-boundaries*,
*And Kabushumba Itimba*,
*Push on, Munyaninga, Giant Spear of Nyababa.*

Kijuju yashonda akalamwita.
Lwona akalafa kashonda kalakaita.
(Wagitela--)
Change in Melody
Chuma,
Chuma abana
Chuma *Njolombi-lubibi*,
Na Kabushumba Itimba,
Chuma Munyaninga, *Kichumu kya Nyababa* .